means of access for inspections, intended to facilitate close-up inspections and thickne ss measurements of the ship■s structure referred to in SOLAS regulation II-1/3-6 on Acce ss to and within spaces in the cargo area of oil tankers and bulk carriers.

Definitions Terms used in the Technical provisions have the same meaning as those define d in the 1974 SOLAS Convention, as amended, and in resolution A.744(18), as amended.

Technical provisions 1 Structural members subject to the close-up inspections and thickn ess measurements of the ship■s structure referred to in SOLAS regula tion II-1/3-6, exce pt those in double bottom spaces, shall be provided with a permanent means of acce ss to the extent as specified in table 1 and table 2, as applicable.

For oil tankers and wing ba llast tanks of ore carriers, rafting may be used in addition to the specified permanent means of access, provided that the structure allows for its s afe and effective use.

2 Elevated passageways, where fitted, sha ll have a minimum width of 600 mm and be provi ded with toe boards not less than 150 mm high and guard rails over both sides of their e ntire - safe and effective use.

2 Elevated passageways, where fitted, sha ll have a minimum width of 600 mm and be provi ded with toe boards not less than 150 mm high and guard rails over both sides of their e ntire length.

Sloping structure providing part of the access shall be of a non-skid construction.

Guard rails shall be 1,000 mm in height and consist of a rail and intermediate bar 500 m m in height and of substantial construction.

Stanchions shall be not more than 3 m apart.

3 Access to elevated passageways and vertical openings from the ship■s bottom shall be p rovided by means of easily accessible passageways, la dders or treads.

Treads shall be provided with lateral support for the foot.

Where the rungs of ladders are fitted against a vertical surface, the distance from the centre of the rungs to the surface shall be at least 150 mm.

Where vertical manholes are fitted higher than 600 mm above the walking level, access sh all be facilitated by means of treads and hand grips with platform landings on both side s.

RESOLUTION MSC.133(76) (adopted on 12 December 2002) ADOPTION OF TECHNICAL PROVISIONS FO R MEANS OF ACCESS FOR INSPECTIONSMSC 76/23/Add.1 ANNEX 2 - means of treads and hand grip s with platform landings on both sides.

RESOLUTION MSC.133(76) (adopted on 12 December 2002) ADOPTION OF TECHNICAL PROVISIONS FO R MEANS OF ACCESS FOR INSPECTIONSMSC 76/23/Add.1 ANNEX 2 Page 3 I:\MSC\76\23-ADD.1.DOC 4 Tunnels passing through cargo holds shall be e quipped with ladders or steps at each end of the hold so that personnel may easily cross such tunnels.

5 Permanent ladders, except for vertical ladders, which are fitted on vertical structure s for close-up inspection or thickness measurement, shall be inclined at an angle of les s than 70”.

There shall be no obstructions within 750 mm of th e face of the inclined ladder, except that in way of an opening this clearance may be reduced to 600 mm.

The flights of ladders shall not be more than 9 m in actual length.

Resting platform s of adequat